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THE K. PATRICIA CROSS ACADEMY

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Activity 7.1: Instructor Motivation Quiz

We often think about student motivation and how to promote and encourage it, but we think less frequently about our own motivation. The Instructor Motivation Quiz is an informal assessment with questions that help you identify your motivation for teaching. Considering what incentivizes us as instructors can provide us with a glimpse into why we make the choices we do and may help us be more effective in implementing strategies that motivate students.

1. To feel sufficiently affirmed in my teaching, I would like…

- ○ A good relationship with my students.
- ○ A fully enrolled course every time I offer it.
- ○ An award for my teaching.
- ☑ A general sense that my teaching matters.
- ○ A regular load of courses to teach

2. I'd feel discouraged if students didn't...

- ○ Ask questions in class or connect with me outside class, such as communicating with me or coming to office hours.
- ○ Accomplish the learning goals I set.
- ○ Listen respectfully to my information and ideas.
- ☑ Seem to care about their learning or the course content.
- ○ Show up for class.

3. To know I had attained my teaching goals, I'd have to...

- ○ Have students stay in touch with me.
- ☑ See evidence that students had achieved the learning goals and objectives for the term.
- ○ Receive student evaluations that indicate the course and my teaching were great.
- ○ Feel a general sense of peace and well-being regarding my teaching.
- ○ Finish grading for the semester.

4. I'll feel I've achieved enough in my teaching when...

- ○ I hear so from my students, peers, or administrators.
- ☑ My students go on to do great things.
- ○ I receive formal recognition of my accomplishments accomplishments, such as through merit review or awards.
- ○ I am able to be present in the moment with my students or be there when they have an “ah ha” moment.
- ○ I retire.

5. To attain satisfaction in teaching, I'd be willing to...

- [x] Invite a peer to watch me teach and then discuss the session afterwards.
- [ ] Share my work with others at my home institution or at a conference.
- [ ] Complete a teaching certificate or other professional development activity.
- [ ] Read inspiring books or articles about teaching and learning.
- [ ] Do whatever I am expected to do at my institution.

6. I know my teaching is going well as long as I have...

- [ ] Good connections with students.
- [x] Helped students learn .
- [ ] Regular recognition for teaching in merit or promotion and tenure reviews.
- [ ] A sense of satisfaction.
- [ ] A regular contract for employment/ teaching.

7. I'd feel my teaching is sufficiently influential if I could...

- ○ Have students remember my class and stay in touch over the years.
- ☑ Have students use things they have learned in my class in other classes and in their jobs.
- ○ Win a teaching award.
- ○ Learn everything I can about pedagogy and learning and bring it to my teaching.
- ○ Be hired in a tenure track or long-term teaching job.

8. To earn appreciation and respect from my students, I would...

- ○ Try to connect with each student to make a difference in their learning.
- ○ Try to inspire them with personal stories.
- ○ Recount my successes.
- ☑ Learn everything I can about my discipline and about teaching so that I do the best job possible.
- ○ Show up on time and be there when needed.

9. For me, "dressing well" for teaching means wearing...

- ○ Clothing similar to other members of my discipline or field.
- ☑ “Professional” attire (e.g. ., business casual).
- ○ Expensive or fashionable clothing.
- ○ Whatever I want.
- ○ The basics/meet dress expectations at my institution.

10. One of the most important aspects of my teaching is...

- ○ My interactions with students.
- ☑ My influence over student learning.
- ○ Teaching recognitions and rewards.
- ○ My calling to teach.
- ○ Being employed.

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- Each question is worth 5 points.
- A score of 15+ in a category means this is an important motivator for you.
- A score of less than 10 in any category means the factor is less motivating to you.

Category Descriptions

Connection**: 5**
This motivation style is characterized by a strong desire to be a part of a group or community. People with this style feel happiest and most fulfilled when they're surrounded by others, whether in a small gathering or a large social movement. Collaboration and teamwork are highly valued, and solitary pursuits may feel isolating or unfulfilling.

Security**: 0**
This motivation style is focused on stability and structure. People with this style want to feel secure in their professional lives and prefer the structure of an organization. They value predictability and prefer to know what to expect regarding income, job responsibilities, and future prospects. This style is often associated with a desire for financial stability and the security of having a regular income.

Influence**: 30**
This motivation style is focused on leadership and inspiring others. People with this style enjoy imagining and bringing new ideas to life,

and they have a natural ability to lead and motivate others to act in positive ways. They thrive on the process of getting others to follow their vision, and they're often seen as natural-born leaders.

Accomplishment**: 0**

This motivation style is driven by a desire for recognition and measurable success. People with this style enjoy activities that involve a clear "win" or achievement. They may turn anything into a competition and enjoy the feeling of being the best at what they do. They thrive on external validation and recognition for their achievements.

Enlightenment**: 15**

This motivation style is focused on a deeper sense of purpose and meaning.

People with this style may feel less motivated by external rewards like wealth or fame and instead seek a greater understanding of their place in the world. They may contemplate their role and responsibilities in a larger cosmic context and may be driven by a desire for personal growth and self-discovery

Note: This is an informal assessment intended simply to provide you with a starting point for reflection.

Congratulations on completion of activity 7.1: Instructor Motivation Quiz

To complete the formal process a self-reflection has been included. Are you interested in completing a self reflection on this activity.

- ○ Yes, I will complete the self-assessment
- ☑ No, I am not interested in completing the self-assessment, please provide me my output